

GERMANY

Visa Application Guide for Pakistani Applicants

Student Visa & Short-Stay (Schengen) Visas — Tourist & Visiting Family/Friends

This guide is based on the official pages of the German Missions in Pakistan (Embassy Islamabad and Consulate General Karachi, published via pakistan.diplo.de). It covers the **Student Visa** and two common **Short-Stay/Schengen visa** categories — Tourist and Visiting Friends/Family. Germany's visa process is now almost entirely digital, via the Consular Services Portal and the Videx online system, so read Section 4 carefully before you begin.

■ Beware of fraud and fake appointment offers

The German Missions and their appointment partners state clearly that appointments cannot be booked over the phone or by unofficial agents, and that only genuine confirmation emails from the official portals are valid. Never pay any third party who claims they can guarantee you an appointment slot — this is a common scam targeting visa applicants.

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1. Know Your Visa Type

Visa Type	Purpose	Notes
Schengen Short-Stay Visa (Cat. C)	Tourism/sightseeing, visiting friends/family, business, medical treatment, short training	Max. 90 days in any 180-day period, across the Schengen Area
National (Long-Stay) Visa (Cat. D) — Student	Enrolment in a German university/study programme	Applied for via the Consular Services Portal; leads to a German residence title after arrival
Airport Transit Visa (Cat. A)	Transit through the international zone of a German airport only	Does not permit entry into Germany itself

2. Islamabad vs Karachi — Jurisdiction

German consular services in Pakistan are split between the Embassy in Islamabad and the Consulate General in Karachi.

Mission	Covers	Key notes
Embassy of Germany, Islamabad	Islamabad Capital Territory, Gilgit-Baltistan, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Azad Jammu & Kashmir, and Punjab	Student visa applications go through the Consular Services Portal linked to this mission
Consulate General of Germany, Karachi	Sindh and Balochistan	The Consular Services Portal for student visas is also active for Karachi applicants, via the same online system

For short-stay (Schengen) visas, applications are made through the Videx online system and then submitted at the Visa Section serving your place of residence — confirm the correct submission point for your city when you book your appointment.

3. Visa Fees (General)

Visa Category	Fee (EUR)
Schengen Visa (category “C”)	€90.00
Schengen Visa — children age 6–12	€45.00
Airport transit visa (category “A”)	€90.00
Long-term/National visa (category “D”)	€75.00
Family reunion — children age 0–17	€37.50
Dependents of EU citizens	Exempt

Fees are payable in PKR in cash at the counter, calculated at the current exchange rate, at both the Islamabad Embassy and the Karachi Consulate-General.

Standard Schengen processing time

For a Schengen (short-stay) visa application, standard processing is around **14 calendar days** from the date the complete application is submitted. National (long-stay) visa processing times vary widely depending on the purpose of stay and the completeness/quality of your documents.

Remonstrations procedure abolished

As of 1 July 2025, the voluntary objection ('remonstration') procedure for an initial visa refusal has been permanently cancelled. If your application is refused, there is no informal review route through the Embassy — plan your documentation carefully the first time.

4. Student Visa — Consular Services Portal Procedure

Germany's student visa process for Pakistan is fully digital through the **Consular Services Portal**.

4.1 How the process works

Step 1. Register and complete the interactive questionnaire on the Consular Services Portal. Appointment registrations are handled entirely through this portal.

Step 2. The required document list is generated automatically for you after the questionnaire, based on your specific situation.

Step 3. Scan and upload all requested documents through the portal.

Step 4. A visa officer performs an initial screening of your uploaded documents.

Step 5. You will then be informed of one of two outcomes: (1) you receive an appointment notification, or (2) you are asked to submit further or corrected documents.

■ Incomplete applications cause delays

Incomplete applications directly slow down processing. The consular section has stated it is processing a high volume of student visa applications and that demand continues to exceed capacity — repeated inquiries about status further reduce the capacity available to process applications, so applicants are asked to avoid unnecessary follow-ups.

4.2 Mandatory documents (read carefully)

Due to a known technical issue, the online portal currently marks some documents as “optional” when they are, in fact, **mandatory**. If you do not submit them, your online registration will remain halted even though the system does not clearly say so upfront.

- Past degree certificates (school, Bachelor's, or previous Master's degrees, as applicable)
- Degree transcripts
- Proof of payment of tuition fees, where applicable to your course of study

✓ Submit these immediately

Don't wait for a reminder email about these three items — submitting them upfront, even though the portal may label them optional, will make your application run noticeably faster.

4.3 Preparing your documents — general advice

- Prepare all documents and confirmations well in advance, even before it's officially your turn
- Prepare well-readable copies in **A4 format**
- Sort your documents in the correct order as specified by the portal

The Embassy notes that appointment slots move faster for everyone when applicants ahead in the queue present their documents in an orderly fashion — so a well-prepared file benefits both you and other applicants.

4.4 Karachi applicants

The Consular Services Portal is also active for Karachi. Applicants resident in **Sindh and Balochistan** submit their Student Visa applications through the same online portal used for Islamabad-jurisdiction applicants.

5. Tourist Visa (Schengen Short-Stay)

For sightseeing, city visits or a holiday in Germany. Applications are made via the Videx online system.

■ Submit exactly as instructed

Include every document listed below, in exactly the order described. Missing even one document can lead to your application being rejected immediately, and processing does not begin until your file is complete. The Visa Section may request further documents at any time — your application is only complete once you've provided them. All photocopies must be in A4 format.

#	Document	Format & Notes
1	Current & all previous passports, plus visas	Originals of all passports; copies of pages 1–2 of the current one. Valid ≥3 months beyond visa expiry. Must be signed by the holder — unsigned Pakistani passports are invalid and cannot receive a visa.
2	Videx visa application form	Signed original, printed after completing the Videx online system.
3	Two biometric passport photos	Original, no older than 6 months; one stapled to the form, one paper-clipped.
4	Health/travel insurance policy	Signed original + 1 copy. Minimum cover €30,000, valid for all Schengen states (not Germany alone). Must be from an approved provider.
5	Proof of accommodation	Copy/printout covering the whole stay (hotel bookings + full itinerary).
6	Flight reservation	Copy/printout of confirmed round-trip tickets covering your stay.
7	Employment/university confirmation + NOC	Original letter stating your position or study status, duration, and permission for the trip.
8	Previous visa refusals	Copy of any earlier refusal. Non-disclosure is treated as fraud and is automatic grounds for refusal.
9	CNIC	Copy.
10	FRC / Marriage / Birth Certificate	Original NADRA certificate(s), as applicable (Birth Certificate for minor applicants).
11	List of children	Signed original, using the official template.
12	List of relatives living abroad	Signed original, using the official template.
13	Financial evidence	Copy of bank statements (last 6 months) and salary slips (last 3 months) at minimum; pension books, investment certificates or property documents may supplement this, with English translations.
14	Appointment email	Printout showing the email address registered with the Embassy.

6. Visiting Family or Friends (Schengen Short-Stay)

For visiting family or friends resident in Germany. The document set overlaps almost entirely with the Tourist visa (Section 5), with one key difference: proof of the invitation from your host.

Document	Format & Notes
Invitation letter & assurances	Either (a) a formal letter of obligation (Verpflichtungserklärung) issued by the host's local Foreigners Office (Ausländerbehörde) under §§ 66–68 of the Residence Act — must be less than 6 months old — or (b) an informal letter of invitation signed by the host, with copies of the host's passport, residence permit and certificate of residence attached. If you are not staying with your host, confirmed hotel bookings or other accommodation proof is required instead.
All other documents	Same as the Tourist visa checklist in Section 5: passport(s), Videx form, biometric photos, health insurance (min. €30,000, Schengen-wide), flight reservation, employment/university confirmation + NOC, previous refusals, CNIC, FRC/marriage/birth certificate, list of children, list of relatives abroad, financial evidence, and the appointment email printout.

As with the tourist category, an incomplete or incorrectly ordered application can be rejected immediately, and any undisclosed previous visa refusal is treated as fraud.

7. Blocked Account & Financial Requirements

For long-stay (including student) visa applicants, showing sufficient funds to cover your living costs is central to your application. There are three recognised routes:

7.1 Blocked bank account (Sperrkonto)

■ Current requirement

From 1 January 2025, the amount that must be deposited into a blocked account is **€992.00 per month**, i.e. **€11,904.00 per year**. This applies to all visa applications submitted from that date onward. The Embassy/Consulate-General reserve the right to require funds for up to two years in particular cases.

- You may choose any blocked-account provider, provided it offers authorities a login/verification code or a direct contact for verification purposes
- Your signature on the account-opening documents must be attested by the Embassy Islamabad, the Consulate-General Karachi, or the Honorary Consul in Lahore
- Bring your passport and a black-and-white copy of the signature page to the attestation appointment
- The attestation fee is **€25** (approx. PKR 5,400, subject to exchange-rate change), payable in the exact amount — if you can't provide exact change, you will need to rebook
- The attestation appointment and the visa-submission appointment must be booked **separately**

7.2 Deed of obligation (Verpflichtungserklärung)

A sponsor residing in Germany can sign a declaration of liability under §§ 66–68 of the Residence Act at their local Migration Office, proving sufficient means (e.g. 6 months of payslips and bank statements). By signing, the sponsor takes on responsibility for costs you might incur during your stay in Germany.

7.3 Official scholarship

A scholarship can also demonstrate sufficient means — but note that a scholarship awarded by a **Pakistani university alone is not sufficient**. Only scholarships awarded by the **HEC (Higher Education Commission)**, or a German/other foreign official scholarship body, are accepted.

8. Required Documents — Quick Reference

Category	Student Visa	Tourist / Visiting Family
Core ID	Passport, CNIC	Passport (+ all previous passports), CNIC
Application form	Consular Services Portal questionnaire (online)	Videx form, printed & signed
Academic docs	Degree certificates, transcripts, tuition-fee payment proof, admission letter	N/A (unless letter of employer/university confirms study status for the trip)
Financial proof	Blocked account (€992/month or €11,904/year) OR deed of obligation OR HEC/official scholarship	Bank statements (6 months) + salary slips (3 months), supplemented as needed
Insurance	Health insurance appropriate to your stay in Germany	Min. €30,000, Schengen-wide cover
Accommodation	Proof of housing arrangements in Germany	Hotel bookings / host's letter of obligation or informal invitation
Family documents	As requested case-by-case	FRC, marriage/birth certificate, list of children, list of relatives abroad

9. Application-Day Checklist

- Printed appointment confirmation email (showing your registered email address)
- Original passport(s) — current and all previous — all signed by the holder
- Completed & signed application form (Videx printout for short-stay; portal-generated set for student visa)
- Two biometric photos, no older than 6 months
- Complete document set in the order specified by the portal/Embassy, copies in A4 format
- Visa fee in cash, in PKR, in the exact amount if possible
- Blocked-account attestation receipt or deed of obligation (for long-stay/student applicants)

10. Fraud & Appointment Warnings

■ Appointments cannot be bought or guaranteed

All appointment bookings go through the official Consular Services Portal or Videx system. Be cautious of any individual or agency offering to “guarantee” you a faster appointment or a visa outcome — the German Missions do not authorise third parties to sell or reserve appointment slots. Only trust confirmation emails generated directly by the official portals.

- Do not disclose your Consular Services Portal or Videx login credentials to anyone
- Verify any communication claiming to be from the Embassy/Consulate against the official domain (diplo.de)
- Report suspected fraud or scam offers to the Embassy/Consulate-General directly rather than engaging further with the offer

11. Official Source List

This guide was compiled from the following official pages of the German Missions in Pakistan. Always verify current fees, blocked-account amounts and procedural details directly on these pages before applying, as requirements are updated periodically (e.g. the blocked-account threshold changes annually).

Visa: Students (Consular Services Portal procedure): <https://pakistan.diplo.de/pk-en/service/2-study-visa-seite-1676104>

Tourist visa: <https://pakistan.diplo.de/pk-en/service/3-tourist-visa-seite-1673122>

Visiting friends and family: <https://pakistan.diplo.de/pk-en/service/2-visitors-visa-seite-1673128>

Visa: General Information (fees & processing times): <https://pakistan.diplo.de/pk-en/service/2208622-2208622>

How to finance your stay (blocked account / deed of obligation / scholarships):
<https://pakistan.diplo.de/pk-en/service/1995528-1995528>

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